United Public Adjusters Non-Profit Organization

CLIENT INFORMATION PACKAGE

Table of Contents:

A. Introduction
   1. Our Mission and Values
   2. The Claim Process Overview

B. What to Expect: Step by Step Guide
   1. Initial Consultation
   2. Claim Assessment and Inspection
   3. Documentation and Evidence Gathering
   4. Strategy and Presentation of the Claim
   5. Negotiation and Settlement
   6. Claim Resolution and Closure

C. Timelines & Milestones
   1. Initial Consultation to Claim Filing
   2. Claim Filing to Insurance Company Response
   3. Negotiation Period
   4. Settlement and Resolution

D. Your Role & Responsibilities
   1. Provide Accurate Information
   2. Cooperation and Communication
   3. Sit Back and Relax

E. Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)
   1. What is a Public Adjuster?
   2. How Much Does It Cost to Hire a Public Adjuster?
   3. Will My Premiums Increase if I File a Claim?
   4. How Do I Know If I Have a Valid Claim

F. Our Commitment to You
   1. Transparent Communication
   2. Confidentiality and Privacy
   3. Advocacy for Your Best Interests

Disclaimer - This material is copyrighted and intended solely for the use of UPA 501(c)(3)

A. INTRODUCTION

Here we will be outlining the background for our company activities, describing the mission statement, and providing an overview of the claim process:

1. MISSION STATEMENT

i. **Our mission is to provide compassionate and expert assistance to individuals and communities facing the challenges of navigating insurance claims in the aftermath of disasters and emergencies. As a non-profit organization, our primary goal is to advocate for policyholders, ensuring they receive fair and just settlements from their insurance companies.**

1. ***Empowerment through Education****: We believe in empowering policyholders with knowledge about their rights and entitlements within their insurance policies. Through educational resources, workshops, and outreach programs, we aim to equip individuals with the information necessary to make informed decisions during the claims process.*

2. ***Unbiased Advocacy****: As a non-profit entity, we are committed to providing unbiased and impartial representation for our clients. Our focus is solely on protecting the interests of policyholders, regardless of their financial situation, ensuring they receive equitable settlements to rebuild their lives.*

3. ***Community Resilience****: We recognize the importance of community resilience in the face of disasters. Our mission extends beyond individual claims, as we actively engage in initiatives that foster community preparedness, response, and recovery, creating a stronger and more resilient society.*

4. ***Social Responsibility****: We uphold the values of social responsibility, transparency, and integrity in all our interactions. As a non-profit public adjusting firm, we reinvest back into our educational programs and community initiatives, furthering our commitment to serving the public interest.*

Disclaimer - This material is copyrighted and intended solely for the use of UPA 501(c)(3)

5. ***Advocacy for Vulnerable Populations****: We prioritize our services to assist vulnerable populations who may face additional challenges in the claims process. Through tailored support and advocacy, we strive to ensure equitable access to insurance resources for all policyholders.*

6. ***Excellence in Service****: Our team of experienced public adjusters is dedicated to providing the highest level of service to our clients. We employ industry best practices, maintain the highest ethical standards, and continuously seek professional development to enhance our expertise.*

7. ***Collaboration and Partnerships****: We actively seek collaboration with governmental agencies, community organizations, and other stakeholders to create a network of support for policyholders during times of crisis. By fostering partnerships, we can maximize our impact and extend our reach to those in need.*

ii. By embodying these principles, United Public Adjusters Non-Profit Organization aims to be a beacon of support and assistance for policyholders facing the daunting task of navigating insurance claims in times of adversity. Together, with the communities we serve, we strive to rebuild lives, restore hope, and promote a more resilient and secure future for all.

2. THE CLAIM PROCESS OVERVIEW

i. The insurance claim process can be overwhelming, which is why we are here to simplify it for you. Our team of skilled and experienced public adjusters will act on your behalf to maximize your claim settlement, enabling you to focus on rebuilding and moving forward.

ii. In the following sections, we will outline the step-by-step process of handling your claim, the timelines involved, and your role in the process. We encourage you to read this package thoroughly and feel free to reach out to us if you have any questions or concerns.

Disclaimer - This material is copyrighted and intended solely for the use of UPA 501(c)(3)

B. WHAT TO EXPECT: A STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE

Here we will be outlining what to expect, describing every step in close detail:

1. INITIAL CONSULTATION

i. **The claim process begins with an initial consultation, where one of our dedicated public adjusters will meet with you to gather details about your insurance policy, the nature of your loss, and any evidence or documentation you have regarding the damages. This consultation is free of charge, and there is no obligation.**

2. CLAIM ASSESSMENT AND INSPECTION

i. **Following the initial consultation, our team will conduct a comprehensive assessment of your claim. This involves:**

1. ***Insurance Policy Analysis****: Our professionals undertake a thorough examination of the policy's terms, conditions, coverages, and exclusions to gain a comprehensive understanding of the policyholder's entitlements and potential limitations in the event of a claim. Our experienced adjusters pay close attention to the specific provisions relevant to the policyholder's circumstances, identifying any potential gray areas or areas of interpretation that could impact the claim's outcome.*

2. ***Thorough Inspection****: We deploy skilled and experienced adjusters who are knowledgeable in property damage assessments. These professionals have expertise in identifying various types of damages and understanding the complexities of insurance policies. We meticulously document visible damages as well as hidden or latent damages that might not be immediately apparent.*

3. ***Informed Discussion:*** *We will discuss our findings with you and keep you informed every step of the way, maintaining a high level of transparency and clarity in all communications.*

Disclaimer - This material is copyrighted and intended solely for the use of UPA 501(c)(3)

3. DOCUMENTATION AND EVIDENCE GATHERING

i. **To strengthen your claim, we will work closely with you to gather all relevant documentation and evidence related to the damages. This may include photographs, videos, repair estimates, medical reports, or any other supporting documents required to substantiate your claim.**

1. ***Damage Examination:*** *We conduct a comprehensive inspection of the property, meticulously examining all damages sustained due to the covered event. While insurance adjusters may take a glance, we take our time and carefully note all the damages that have been sustained, so that you are fully accounted for.*

2. ***Evidence Documentation:*** *We take high-quality photographs of the damaged property from multiple angles, capturing details of the losses incurred. These images serve as crucial visual evidence during the claims process. In addition to photographs, the adjusters may also record video footage to provide a comprehensive overview of the damages. Detailed written notes and descriptions are made during the inspection to provide context and specific details about each aspect of the damage.*

3. ***Detailed Estimate Calculation:*** *We leverage advanced tools and software to ensure precise and data-driven assessments. We utilize computer-aided estimating software that can process the collected data and generate itemized estimates automatically. These programs take into account various factors, such as materials, labor costs, local pricing, prevailing building codes, and overhead. With access to historical data and industry benchmarks, we can perform data analytics to compare similar cases and accurately assess the projected costs of repairs or replacements. We integrate machine learning algorithms into our estimating processes. These algorithms continuously improve their accuracy over time by learning from past claims and adjusting estimates accordingly.*

4. STRATEGY AND PRESENTATION OF THE CLAIM

i. **Once we have compiled all necessary evidence, we will professionally present your claim to the insurance company, leaving no room for ambiguity or misinterpretation. Our goal is to achieve a fair and equitable settlement that adequately covers your losses.**

Disclaimer - This material is copyrighted and intended solely for the use of UPA 501(c)(3)

1. ***Maximize Value:*** *We strategize the most effective approach to maximize the claim's value. We identify potential areas of dispute and develop a plan to negotiate with the insurance company for a fair and just settlement.*

2. ***Added Validation****: If necessary, we may consult with industry experts, engineers, or contractors to validate the extent of damages and the estimated cost of repairs or replacements.*

3. ***In-Depth Report****: Finally, we compile a comprehensive claim file, including all evidence, documentation, estimates, and reports. This information is presented in a well-structured manner, providing a clear and logical explanation of the damages and the basis for the claim.*

5. NEGOTIATION AND SETTLEMENT

i. **In the negotiation phase, our experienced public adjusters will engage in discussions with the insurance company on your behalf. We are skilled negotiators, committed to maximizing your claim settlement. Throughout this process, we will provide regular updates on the progress and any settlement offers received.**

1. ***Strategic Negotiation:*** *We engage in strategic negotiation with the insurance company's representatives. We leverage our expertise and knowledge of insurance policies to effectively communicate the policyholder's entitlement to coverage and fair compensation for the damages.*

2. ***Empowering the Policyholder:*** *We ensure that the policyholder is involved in the negotiation process and empowered to make informed decisions. They explain the available options, potential trade-offs, and the implications of various settlement scenarios.*

3. ***Fair and Just Settlement:*** *Our primary goal is to secure a fair and just settlement for the policyholder. We work diligently to maximize the value of the claim and obtain compensation that adequately covers the damages and losses suffered.*

Disclaimer - This material is copyrighted and intended solely for the use of UPA 501(c)(3)

4. ***Note**: In general, most property insurance claims are settled through the standard claims process. However, some claims extend into arbitration and litigation.*

ii. **Appraisal/Umpire**

1. ***Explanation:** Appraisal is a method of dispute resolution used to settle disagreements. Both the insurance company and the policyholder will have third-party appraisers get involved. An umpire is a neutral and impartial third-party appointed to resolve disputes between the insurance company's appraiser and the policyholder's appraiser during the appraisal process.*

2. ***Causes:** Appraisal may be triggered when there are disputes over various aspects of the claim, such as coverage, valuation of damages, extent of losses, insurance company conduct, or any other matter related to the insurance policy.*

3. ***Solution:** We have access to a network of experienced and professional appraisers who work with our adjusters to assist in claim resolution.*

iii. **Litigation**

1. ***Explanation:** Litigation is a method of dispute resolution used to settle disagreements. The court system is used if a settlement is not reached through negotiation.*

2. ***Causes:** Litigation is a result of the insurance company's failure to cooperate with our team of professionals. A bad faith practice may be relevant if litigation has arisen.*

3. ***Solution:** To ensure that you have access to the highest level of expertise and advocacy, our public adjusting team is armed with top lawyers who specialize in property insurance litigation.*

6. CLAIM RESOLUTION AND CLOSURE

i. **Upon reaching a mutually agreeable settlement, we will guide you through the final steps of claim resolution. We will ensure all necessary paperwork**

Disclaimer - This material is copyrighted and intended solely for the use of UPA 501(c)(3)

is completed accurately, and the settlement amount is promptly disbursed to you.

Disclaimer - This material is copyrighted and intended solely for the use of UPA 501(c)(3)

C. TIMELINES AND MILESTONES

We understand the importance of timely action in the claim process. Here are the estimated timelines for the key milestones involved:

1. INITIAL CONSULTATION TO CLAIM FILING

i. **Within 48 hours of contacting us, we will schedule the initial consultation. Following the consultation, we aim to file your claim within 3-5 business days.**

2. CLAIM FILING TO INSURANCE COMPANY RESPONSE

i. **After filing your claim, we anticipate receiving the insurance company's initial response within 2-4 weeks.**

3. NEGOTIATION PERIOD

i. **Negotiations with the insurance company typically last between 2-6 weeks, depending on the complexity of the claim and the cooperation of the involved parties.**

ii. **If the claim goes into appraisal:**

1. *Appraiser Assignment: The insurance company appoints an appraiser to assess the damages independently. 1 week.*
2. *Appraiser Evaluation/Negotiation: 2-6 weeks.*
3. *Appraiser Settlement: 2-4 weeks.*

iii. **If the claim goes into Umpire:**

1. *The time it takes for a property insurance claim to be settled after going to an umpire can vary depending on several factors, including the complexity of the claim, the availability of the umpire, and the willingness of both parties to accept the umpire's decision. In general, the claim settlement process after umpire appraisal can take anywhere from a few weeks to a couple of months.*

iv. **If the claim goes into Lawsuit:**

Disclaimer - This material is copyrighted and intended solely for the use of UPA 501(c)(3)

1. *A lawsuit in the context of a property insurance claim is a time-consuming task due to its legal nature, the complexities involved, and the variability in factors that can influence the duration of the process.*

4. SETTLEMENT AND RESOLUTION

i. **Upon successful negotiations, the claim resolution process may take 1-3 weeks for the settlement amount to be disbursed to you.**

*Please note that these timelines are estimates, and the actual duration may vary based on specific circumstances and the responsiveness of the insurance company.

Disclaimer - This material is copyrighted and intended solely for the use of UPA 501(c)(3)

D. YOUR ROLE AND RESPONSIBILITIES

Here we will be outlining your role as a client, providing insight into what to expect:

1. PROVIDE ACCURATE INFORMATION

i. **To ensure the success of your claim, it is crucial that you provide accurate and detailed information regarding the damages, the cause of loss, and any other relevant details. Open and transparent communication with our team will facilitate a smooth and efficient claims process.**

2. COOPERATION AND COMMUNICATION

i. **During the claim process, we may require your assistance in providing additional documentation or answering queries from the insurance company. Your cooperation and timely responses are vital to the progress of your claim.**

3. SIT BACK AND RELAX

i. **We understand your tough situation, and we thank you for your patience in the claim process. Do not worry, we got your back!**

Disclaimer - This material is copyrighted and intended solely for the use of UPA 501(c)(3)

E. FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS (FAQS)

Here we will answer commonly asked questions:

1. WHAT IS A PUBLIC ADJUSTER?

i. **A public adjuster is an insurance professional licensed to represent policyholders in their insurance claims. Public adjusters work solely for the policyholder and not the insurance company, advocating for fair and equitable settlements.**

2. HOW MUCH DOES IT COST TO HIRE A PUBLIC ADJUSTER?

i. **As a non-profit organization, our services are provided to you at no upfront cost. We work on a contingency basis, meaning our fees are derived from a percentage of the claim settlement. If we don't succeed in securing a settlement, you owe us nothing.**

3. WILL MY PREMIUMS INCREASE IF I FILE A CLAIM?

i. **Filing a claim should not result in immediate premium increases. Insurance premiums are determined by various factors, including the frequency and severity of claims in your area. If you are concerned about potential rate changes, our team can offer guidance on the best course of action.**

4. HOW DO I KNOW IF I HAVE A VALID CLAIM?

i. **Determining the validity of your claim requires a thorough assessment of your insurance policy and the circumstances surrounding the damages. Our skilled public adjusters will evaluate your claim during the initial consultation and advise you on the best course of action.**

Disclaimer - This material is copyrighted and intended solely for the use of UPA 501(c)(3)

F. OUR COMMITMENT TO YOU

Here we will describe our unwavering commitment to our clients, touching on our best practices and dedication:

1. TRANSPARENT COMMUNICATION

i. **We prioritize open and honest communication with our clients. Throughout the claim process, we will keep you informed of any updates, developments, or settlement offers. We are readily available to address any concerns or questions you may have.**

2. CONFIDENTIALITY AND PRIVACY

i. **Rest assured that all information you share with us is treated with the utmost confidentiality and privacy. We understand the sensitive nature of insurance claims and will handle your data with the highest level of security.**

3. ADVOCACY FOR YOUR BEST INTERESTS

i. **Our commitment to you goes beyond securing a fair settlement.**

1. *We advocate for your best interests, ensuring your rights as a policyholder are protected throughout the claim process.*
2. *United Public Adjusters Non-Profit Organization is here to support and guide you through every step of your insurance claim journey.*
3. *We believe in empowering our clients with knowledge and resources to make informed decisions.*
4. *If you have any further questions or require additional information, please do not hesitate to contact our team. We are honored to be a part of this process with you and are confident that together, we will achieve a positive outcome for your claim.*

Disclaimer - This material is copyrighted and intended solely for the use of UPA 501(c)(3)